Meet Your Inner Critic

Level 2 · Identity Awareness

Name _____ Date _____

Almost every capable person has an inner critic. It is the voice that says you got lucky, that someone will find you out, that you should wait until you are more prepared. The critic is not your enemy. It usually formed to protect you from embarrassment, rejection, or failure. But it was built for an earlier version of you, and it has not noticed that you have grown.

You do not need to silence your critic. You need to stop mistaking it for the truth.

PART 1 Name Your Critic

Giving the critic a name creates distance. It becomes something you notice rather than something you are.

GIVE IT A NAME

My critic is called …

_____

_____

What does it sound like?

Whose voice does it echo? Is it harsh, anxious, sarcastic, or quietly disappointed?

_____

_____

_____

When does it show up most?

The situations, people, or moments that bring it out.

_____

_____

_____

PART 2 Its Script

Write down the critic's most common lines, word for word if you can. Then look at what it is trying to do.

Line 1

WHAT IT SAYS

WHAT IT WANTS ME TO DO

Line 2

WHAT IT SAYS

WHAT IT WANTS ME TO DO

Line 3

WHAT IT SAYS

WHAT IT WANTS ME TO DO

What is it trying to protect you from?

Behind every critical line there is usually a fear. Name it.

What has listening to it cost you?

Opportunities, income, visibility, relationships, rest.

PART 3 Your Answering Voice

For each line, write the response that is true. Use evidence, not cheerleading.

Answer to line 1

THE TRUTH IS

MY EVIDENCE

Answer to line 2

THE TRUTH IS

MY EVIDENCE

Answer to line 3

THE TRUTH IS

MY EVIDENCE

YOUR ANSWERING VOICE IN ONE SENTENCE

When my critic speaks, I will remind myself that …

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